

Product Name : HerNest (?) | PRD

1. *Executive summary and problem statement*

Problem statement : Safety, privacy and compatibility challenges, cluttered market, ease to find people, scams happen, unverified users, creepy messages, lack of lifestyle matching, lack of personalisation, over dependency on broker, post-contract establishment services (house setup help, move-in/move-out assistance etc.)

Solution : female centric platform, secure and verified profiles that connects women looking for rooms with women who have rooms to rent, the 3-personas out of 4 (women with no flat no flatmate, with flat no flatmate, with flatmate but no flat), lifestyle compatibility, end to end security and safety across the two persona domain (mate and owner)

Vision : Safe accommodation for women pan-India.

2. *Target audience and user personas*

Age Group : 18+ to any age.

Persona-1 (The Seeker-Tenant-Kirayedaar) : Connecting two likeminded females wanting a flatmate with similar interest.

Persona-2 (The Host-Existing Tenant) : Professional women/ student with a spare room and wants to rent it out.

Persona-3 (Replacement of the current/moving-out tenant) : Women moving out seeking replacement for the rented space.

Persona-4 (Owner - seeking for female tenants) — ***not in V0.***

3. *Goals and Success metrics* — how will you know the minimum viable product (MVP) is successful?

Acquisition : 8500 verified sign-ups in first 12 weeks (3 months)

Engagement : 40 matches per week

Trust and Safety : 100% of users must pass ID-verification or <1% report rate for harassment

Retention : 25% retention in every 3-day cycle (user hasn't been matched yet)

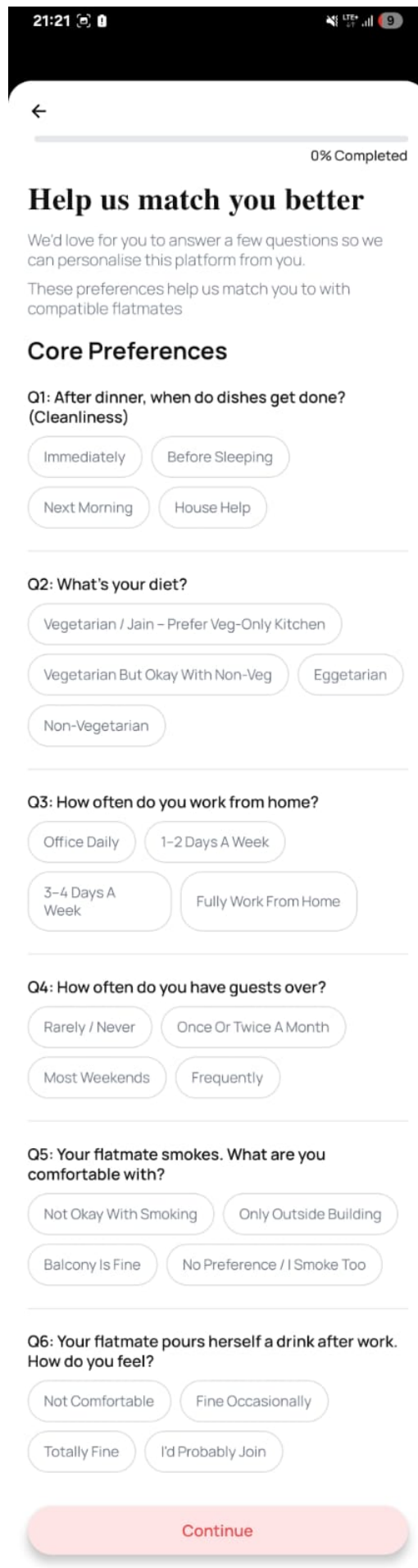
4. Features and Functional requirement

User Journey Breakdown :

- Onboarding and verification :
 - Progressive profiling flow :
 - Step-1 : Hook — email, phone, password — allow users to browse listing without full verification to reduce friction but gate messaging behind verification
 - Step-2 : Basic Identity — first name, last name, age, city
 - Step-3 : Hard verification — ID upload + selfie
 - ID Verification Logic
 - Integration — use an identification-verification API
 - Flow — user selects ID type (Aadhar & PAN) —> Uploads front and back of the ID —> takes a live selfie —> API returns a confidence score
 - Edge cases —
 1. Low confidence score, blurry photo —> prompt user to retake
 2. Name mismatch — if the ID name doesn't matches the sign up name, flag for manual admin review
 3. Gender verification — since this is a female only app the API must verify the gender marker on the ID | **Edge case** —if the ID is non-binary or gender is not listed route to a manual admin review queue to ensure compliance with your specific legal/safety guidelines
 - Verification status state
 - Unverified — can browse with blurred profile but cannot message

- Pending — ID submitted waiting for API/manual check
- Verified — green check, full access
- Rejected — ID failed — prompt to reupload
- Profile creation and listing management : profile needs to be rich enough to determine compatibility but easy to build
 - **About me section**
 1. Bio — free text - 250 characters
 2. Demographics — age, occupation, location, company/ university (optional) — boosts trust
 3. Photo — only one main profile picture
 4. Functional requirement — integrate an image moderation API like AWS recognition to automatically block uploads containing AI images, nudity, weapons or explicit content
 - **The lifestyle questionnaire :**
 1. Do not rely on free text (bio), use standardised multiple choice or sliders so the algorithm can calculate matches
 2. Categories —
 3. Vices and habits

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5. Listing Management (For Hosts):

Room Details: Rent amount, deposit, available date, lease length.

Property Details: Total bedrooms/bathrooms, furnished/unfurnished, amenities (In-unit laundry, dishwasher, AC, parking).

Media: Up to 6 photos of the room and common areas. *Feature:* Video Tour — upload option. (Optional)

Existing flatmate (if any) — names and link to any social media account of the flatmate already in capacity

- House Rules/Preferences — to be listed along the photos of the flats.

6. Search, Filter & Matching Engine

This needs to be fast and highly relevant.

1. Search and Map logic

Geospatial Search: Use Mapbox or Google Maps API. Users search by city, neighborhood, or draw a custom radius on the map. (0-5 kms)

Privacy Constraint: *Never* show the exact pin location of a host's apartment on the public map. Show an approximate radius (e.g., a 200-meter circle) to protect the host's privacy until a viewing is booked.

2. Filtering System:

Hard Filters (Must match): Location, Move-in date, Age (?)

Soft Filters (Nice to have): some of the preferences from the questionnaire (would be optional to fill)

3. The Compatibility Algorithm (The "Match Score"):

Logic: Assign weights to lifestyle questions. (e.g., Smoking match = 20% weight, Cleanliness match = 15% weight, Sleep schedule = 10% weight).

Output: Display a "Compatibility Score" (e.g., "85% Match") on the listing card.

4. Saved Searches & Alerts:

Users can save a search (e.g., "Downtown, under \$1200, pet friendly").

Functional Requirement: Trigger a Push Notification and Email when a *new* listing matches their saved criteria.

7. Communication & Connection

This is where the actual "flatmate finding" happens. It must be secure.

1. In-App Chat Mechanics:

Standard features: Text, read receipts (toggleable in settings), typing indicators.

PII Masking (Crucial): Use Regex to detect and blur phone numbers, email addresses, and Instagram handles in the chat *until* both users have been chatting for X days, OR until both users explicitly click "Share Contact Info". This prevents scammers from moving conversations off-app immediately.

3. The "Viewing" Workflow:

Inside the chat, include a contextual button: **"Request a Viewing"**. When clicked, it opens a mini-calendar. The host can approve a time.

Once approved, the chat generates a "Viewing Card" with the date, time, and a button to "Share Live Location with a Friend" (Safety feature).

7. Edge Cases & Error Handling

- **Edge Case Expected System Behavior** — User uploads an ID with a male name/photo by mistake —> System flags it in Admin queue —> Admin rejects it —> User gets an in-app notification: "Verification failed: —> Regex detects 10-digit number pattern. Message is blocked. —> System shows prompt: "Please use the [Share Number] button to share contact details safely.
- **Lister uploads photos of a different apartment** (stolen from internet) —> Seeker reports listing —> Admin reviews —> Listing is removed —> Lister gets a warning —> Second strike = permanent ban
- **Map API fails to load** —> UI gracefully degrades to List View. A banner says "Map view temporarily unavailable, please use filters.
- **Two users match, but one is a broker posing as a woman.** —> Broker uses a female's ID (with her permission) but acts as a broker in chat —> Seeker reports —> Admin reviews chat transcripts —> Broker banned.

8. Tech Stack — Next.js (Typescript+Node)

- covers both front end as well as the backend —> authentication via firebase —> database on supabase (postgre) —> hosting on vercel

9. UX/UI Guidelines

- Vibe: Clean, trustworthy, modern, and welcoming.
- Avoid overly "pink" stereotypical designs; opt for professional, calming colors (e.g., deep teal, soft coral, crisp white).

- Trust Signals: Verification badges must be highly visible on profiles and listings. Frictionless Flow: Minimize the number of clicks to create a listing. Use progressive disclosure for the lifestyle questionnaire.

10. Scope Definition (Crucial for v0)

To ensure v0 launches quickly

- we must strictly define what is IN and OUT —>
 - In Scope for v0 (Mumbai Only, Women Only) —>
 - User Registration & Strict Identity Verification. Profile Creation (Seeker & Lister) —>
 - Listing Creation (Rooms/PGs) with lifestyle tags —> Search, Filter, and Map-based Discovery —>
 - In-app Chat (to protect phone numbers).
 - Basic Reporting & Blocking. ❌
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- **Out of Scope for v0** — *(Deferred to v1+)*:
 - Expansion to other cities (Delhi, Bangalore, etc.).
 - Male or Unisex listings.
 - In-app rent payments or digital lease agreements.
 - Integration with local brokers or property managers.
 - Native Mobile Apps (v0 will be a Mobile-Responsive Web App / PWA).
 - Brining in the 4th persona (Owner)